Over the past few hundred years, biodiversity has faced major challenges, including a growing demand for biological resources caused by population growth and increased consumption. This increased exploitation of biological resources has resulted in the loss of species at levels currently estimated to be 100 times faster than the natural rate of loss prior to significant human intervention. Though many species were lost and new ones formed, it is likely we will lose all this natural wealth in less than two centuries, if the present rate of biodiversity losses persist.

The biodiversity and its conservation is the important global issue of international concern. Recognition of this problem has made scientists and policy makers to work and develop mechanisms to document, conserve and sustainably use biodiversity.

The younger generation should be made to realize the critical state of biodiversity today and volunteer to protect and conserve it, so as to enable the future generations get to enjoy the benefits of Nature.

Evaluation

1. Which of the following regio n has maximum biodiversity
   a) Taiga
   b) Tropical forest
   c) Temperate rain forest
   d) Mangroves

2. Conservation of biodiversity within their natural habitat is
   ***a) Insitu* conservation**
   b) Exsitu conservation
   c) In vivo conservation
   d) In vitro conservation

3. Which one of the following is not coming under insitu conservation
   a) Sanctuaries b) Natural parks
   c) **Zoological park** d) Biosphere reserve

4. Which of the following is considered a hotspots of biodiversity in India
   a) Western ghats b) Indo-gangetic plain
   c) Eastern Himalayas **d) A and C**

5. The organization which published the red list of species is
   a) WWF **b) IUCN** c) ZSI d) UNEP

6. Who introduced the term biodiversity?
   a) Edward Wilson **b) Walter Rosen**
   c) Norman Myers d) Alice Norman

7. Which of the following forests is known as the lungs of the planet earth?
   a) Tundra forest
   b) Rain forest of north east India
   c) Taiga forest
   d) Amazon rain forest

8. Which one of the following are at high risk extinction due to habitat destruction
   a) Mammals b) Birds
   c) Amphibians d) Echinoderms

9. **Assertion:** The Environmental conditions of the tropics are favourable for speciation and diversity of organisms. **Reason:** The climate seasons, temperature, humidity and photoperiod are more or less stable and congenial.
   a) Both Assertion and Reason are true and Reason explains Assertion correctly.
   b) Both Assertion and Reason are true but Reason is not the correct explanation of Assertion.
   c) Assertion is true , but Reason is false.
   d) Both Assertion and Reason are false.

10. Define the following.
    a. Species richness.
    b. Endemism.

11. How many hotspots are there in India? Name them.

12. What are the three levels of biodiversity?

13. Name the active chemical found in the medicinal plant *Rauwolfia vomitoria*. What type of diversity it belongs to?

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